

Knowledge Organiser (LAUNCH W4): A Timeline of Twentieth-Century Britain

Humanities Aut 1 · 2026–27 · **Workbook outcome:** Build an interactive timeline of 20th-century Britain.

Key Word	Definition
Watch the method:	Watch the method: I take the law against racial discrimination card, read its printed date, 1965, and measure twelve millimetres to the right of 1962 before placing it; I then read its locator aloud and say what came immediately before and after it on the line. Date, measure, place, locator, neighbours, and only then the next card; the ranking waits until the line is complete.
sequence	The diagram above separates the two things a timeline can carry: the sequence on the solid line, fixed by the dates and identical for every question, and the ranking on the dashed strips beneath it, which is rewritten whenever the enquiry question changes; the same four events appear in two different orders on the two strips while never moving on the line.
ranking	The diagram above separates the two things a timeline can carry: the sequence on the solid line, fixed by the dates and identical for every question, and the ranking on the dashed strips beneath it, which is rewritten whenever the enquiry question changes; the same four events appear in two different orders on the two strips while never moving on the line.
Repairing it together:	Repairing it together: rewrite the sentence as “For the question of who lived in Britain, 1948 ranks first because the passenger list and the nationality law locate both the arrival and the right to settle in that year,” which argues from locators and names the question, leaving the line untouched.

Key Facts

- Sequence is fixed by the dates on the cards and is the same for every question; significance is a judgement that changes with the question and must be argued with locators.
- The migration cards from the last three weeks belong on this line, among the wars, Acts and elections, as part of a wider story.

Arrival Task

Retrieving sequence, scale and significance

1) Sequence is fixed by the dates on the cards and is the same for every question; significance is a judgement that changes with the question and must be argued with locators.

2) The migration cards from the last three weeks belong on this line, among the wars, Acts and elections, as part of a wider story.

Why is the order not the same as the importance?

Consider two timelines built from the same cards. Timeline A: the cards are placed in date order with equal gaps between them, and the largest card is the one the builder liked most. Timeline B: the cards are placed in date order at scale, so that 1918 and 1928 sit close together while 1973 and 1979 sit close together, and the ranking for the enquiry question is written on a separate strip beneath the line with a locator for each reason.

We Do 1: Sequence three cards to scale together

Card A: 1965 · the first law against racial discrimination makes discrimination in public places unlawful.

Card B: 1979 · the first woman becomes prime minister of the UK.

Card C: 1945 · the second world war ends and a general election returns a Labour government.

We Do 2: Rank the events for one question together

We build one ranking on the board before anyone writes: each learner records a first-ranked card on a whiteboard with the locator that carries its reason, and only when every board is raised do we compare and agree what a reason that points looks like.

Scaffolding – Stretch

Word Bank

Watch the method:, sequence, ranking, Repairing it together:, Space, Voice, Audience, Influence

Your route

Complete the standard route, then re-rank the same cards for a second question from the supplied list and explain why the ranking changed while the sequence did not.

Sentence frames

"Who ... what they do ... so that ..." | "... because ..."



Reference Zone — keep this beside your work

The model

Watch the method: I take the law against racial discrimination card, read its printed date, 1965, and measure twelve millimetres to the right of 1962 before placing it; I then read its locator aloud and say what came immediately before and after it on the line. Date, measure, place, locator, neighbours, and only then the next card; the ranking waits until the line is complete.

Repairing it together: rewrite the sentence as “For the question of who lived in Britain, 1948 ranks first because the passenger list and the nationality law locate both the arrival and the right to settle in that year,” which argues from locators and names the question, leaving the line untouched.

Check yourself

- Check yourself: does every ranking reason carry a locator?
- Check yourself: is the ranking written on the strip and not on the line?

From the lesson sheet

A Timeline of Twentieth-Century Britain

SoW: 'LAUNCH Weekly - Autumn'!C49 — "Build an interactive timeline of 20th-century Britain."

Learning objective: I can build a scaled, re-rankable timeline of twentieth-century Britain from dated cards and justify a ranking for a stated question with locators.

No learner is asked where their own family was during any event. Every task is completed from the supplied event cards and the scaled line.

The timeline and ranking row

Date → event on the line → rank on the strip for the stated question, with a locator.

The first row is completed for you from the ranking we built together and is set in italics so that it is not mistaken for your own; complete as many of the rows below it as you can.



Independent Work – Stretch

The standard route plus a re-ranking for a second question with an explanation.

Complete the standard route, then re-rank the same cards for a second question from the supplied list and explain why the ranking changed while the sequence did not.

Date and event	Rank for "who lived in Britain"	Reason with locator
1948 · Windrush arrives at Tilbury	<i>first</i>	<i>passenger list and nationality law locate arrival and right to settle</i>

Choose a route

1. I chose my own route.
2. My reasons are in my own words.
3. Any adult help is written on the record.

5 · Learner confirmation

I confirm this is my own work.

Learner name (print)	Signature
Date	

Exit Ticket – Stretch

1) Read your ranking strip to a partner or an adult, who repeats the question they heard it answer.

2) If the listener heard a different question from the one you meant, rewrite the strip heading so the question is unmistakable; the change is yours.

3) SPACE stays available, VOICE is received, AUDIENCE names back exactly and INFLUENCE changes one real next action.

Lundy Loop — this lesson

SPACE stays available, VOICE is received, AUDIENCE names back exactly and INFLUENCE changes one real next action.

Space	,
Voice	
Audience	
Influence	

A Timeline of Twentieth-Century Britain — Feedback Sheet

Keep with your book / folder.

Pupil name:	Date:
WWW (What Went Well): 	
EBI (Even Better If): 	
Level worked at: Supported / Standard / Stretch	Evidence filed: Yes / Not yet
Authorship — what I chose or decided myself: 	
Support given — prepared / scribed / modelled / hand-over-hand: 	
Pupil response — my next step: 	